were the more dangerous as we would invariably end up having gulab jamuns at the iconic eatery Baljees, the aroma being just too hard to resist. We also made some good friends—Raja Bhasin, an expert on Shimla whose walking tour of Shimla is an experience in itself. Chander Mahajan, an elderly gentleman and an expert bridge player, who introduced us to Prabodh and Anurita Saxena, and we would all play bridge together on a Sunday afternoon. In fact, we became such good friends with the Saxenas that when they came to Kolkata for their son's graduation, they managed to find time to come to our residence and play a round of bridge.

We also patronized the Gaiety Theatre, perhaps the oldest in Asia. Established in 1887, it was designed by Henry Irwin and many of our renowned stars, like Anupam Kher and Naseeruddin Shah, began their careers here. Veena, who is fond of the theatre, through her contacts and with the help of Commodore Ahluwalia, managed to stage a play by the theatre director Feisal Alkazi, which was quite a coup. We also got the famous ghazal singer Sudip Banerjee and the equally famous Sufi singers Char Yaar to perform at the Gaiety. With our active involvement, it became a happening place. One of the unique features of this theatre is that each year, they stage a members' play in which the members themselves play the various parts. For the year that we were there, we had chosen *Twelve Angry Jurors*, a play by Reginald Rose, to be staged in October. Unfortunately, we weren't around to see the final performance, as a fresh set of orders was ready for me.

This time it was to go as the Army Commander, Eastern Command, and assume command on 1 September 2018. I wasn't expecting any posting as I had been in Shimla for just a little over six months. Apparently, I needed to be given experience of an operational command; I wasn't out of the race just yet. Once

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